SAN FERNANDO VALLEY - West Valley Food Pantry gets $3.5M in state aid - Assemblyman presents check for nonprofit to expand outreach as need for services grows

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Assemblyman Jesse Gabriel, D-Woodland Hills, buoyed the coffers of the West Valley Food Pantry to the tune of $3.5 million, presenting the organization with a novelty check that represents the recent appropriation in the state budget for the pantry.

The money will help the pantry construct a permanent facility and expand its outreach and services in the west San Fernando Valley, officials said on Monday. A new 7,000-square-foot facility will include an upgraded commercial kitchen.

The funding will aid the pantry's efforts to assist individuals experiencing homelessness. The pantry also has aided families in need in the West Valley during the COVID-19 pandemic.

"The West Valley Food Pantry is a true blessing for our community," Gabriel said. "The pantry has done incredible work supporting vulnerable kids, families, and seniors during the COVID-19 pandemic, and I am thrilled to have secured $3.5 million to help them establish a new facility and grow their efforts to combat hunger and homelessness in the San Fernando Valley."

Over the past 18 months, officials said the nonprofit has experienced a quadrupling of community members in need of its services and has assisted more than 240,000 individuals during that time.

The organization also delivers groceries to more than 600 homebound seniors.

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